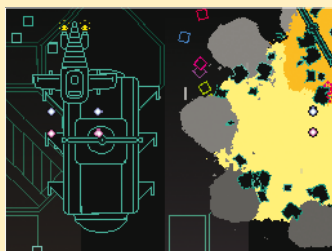


Cactus Arcade

<http://www.cactus-soft.co.nr/>

Jonatan Söderström is a young game designer from Gothenburg, Sweden and Cactus Arcade is a compilation of some of the best games he has released under the banner of his fledgling game development company Cactus / Games. The compilation consists of 17 games that vary across genres—from platformers to shoot 'em ups.

Clean Asia, for example, is a vertical shooter in which you play the role of some US fighter pilots as they go against an alien menace. The game has three levels and two selectable ships, each with unique controls and abilities. It faces you off against fourteen bosses and



around ten regular enemies.

The compilation also contains *Shotgun Ninja*—a platformer, and *SeizureDome* which Jonatan describes as a sumo wrestling game but with guns: the goal is to avoid letting the swarm of enemies push you outside of a ring; using powerups, and special weapons to garner combo kills.

Trilby: The Art of Theft

<http://www.escapistmagazine.com/content/games/yahtzee/artoftheft>

As its name suggests, this game is all about pulling off heists. In *The Art of Theft* you control Trilby, a thief out to “scare the ignorant rich by hitting them where it hurts—their wallets”. It is a mission-based, stealth platformer, presented in 2D and created by Ben “Yahtzee” Croshaw—the British-born author of several adventure games and the hilarious Zero Punctuation series of video reviews.

Your goal in *The Art of Theft* is to infiltrate a variety of

buildings in Chapow City, steal loot, avoid alarms and security guards and get out again without being caught. The game allows you to trigger a certain number of alarms each level, before forcing you to play the level again. Similarly, you can tazer security guards to knock them unconscious—this too can only be done a limited number of times each level. The game then scores you on the basis of time taken, loot stolen, and alarms triggered, and so on.



Karoshi 2.0

<http://gmc.yoyogames.com/index.php?showtopic=369491>

Karoshi and its sequel both consist of a series of levels in which the goal is for the player character to kill himself. The levels are essentially puzzles, each with a different goal—while some might ask you a simple Yes / No question (“Are you an idiot?”), others will see you pushing crates and collecting coins. With progressing levels, the puzzles get more bizarre and clever and the game succeeds in being fun by not resorting to obtuse puzzles. The second game is more varied in its content than its predecessor, which had one too many levels consisting of crate-pushing puzzles.



You Have To Burn The Rope

<http://www.mazapan.se/games/BurnTheRope.php>

Perhaps the shortest game in this list, or not, depending upon the way you interact with games. The game has been described as a “joke” by its creator—the 21-year old half-Persian, half-Finnish Kian Bashiri. Kian describes it as “this really silly idea... a statement about how games are too hard and complicated. It’s also a subtle reference to how some games are kind of patronising toward the player, like too easy.” The tongue-in-cheek nature of the game is also reflected in the ending credit song which declares: Now you are a hero / you managed to beat the whole damn game / we are happy you made it / but how are you gonna spend the rest of the day?

You of course, hit refresh and play it all over again.

